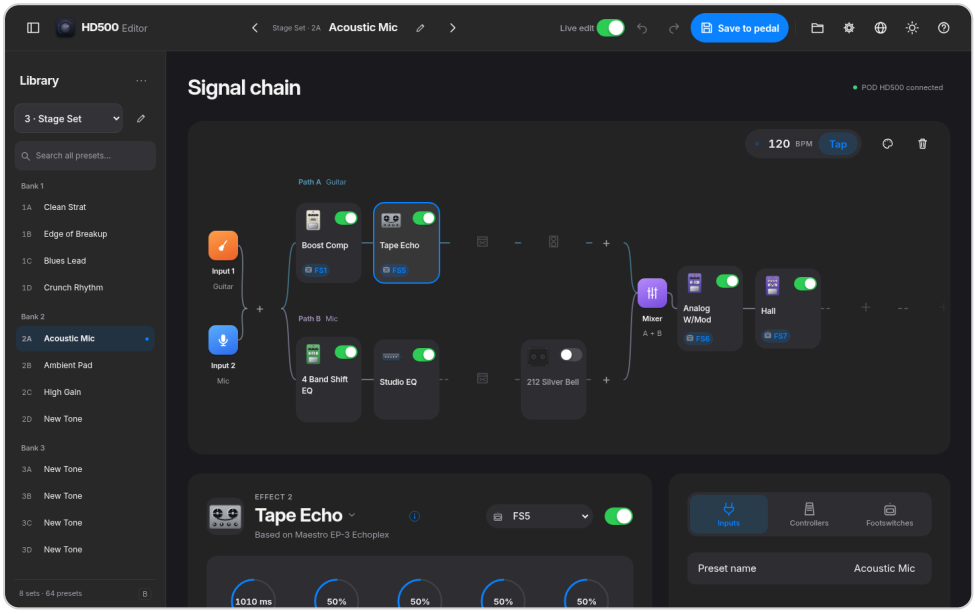
HD500 Editor Windows

Installation and user guide · Version 0.2.12 (beta)

HD500 Editor is a free, open editor for the Line 6 POD HD500 that talks to the pedal directly over USB. It edits amps, cabs, effects, mixer, footswitches and expression pedals live, and manages the 8 libraries of 64 presets.



Limitations

- **Audio OR editor:** on Windows the pedal is either a sound card (Line 6's official driver) *or* editable in HD500 Editor (WinUSB), never both at once. With WinUSB the editor connects but the pedal stops being a sound card. With Line 6's driver the pedal is a sound card but the editor cannot connect.
- To get audio back: reinstall Line 6's driver from **line6.com/software** (version **4.2.7.6** recommended; 4.2.7.7 has an issue reported by Line 6 support). The assistant's "Get the Line 6 audio driver" button opens the page.
- To edit again: run Zadig again (Open Zadig in the assistant).
- **No code signing:** SmartScreen warns during installation.
- Tested on Windows 10 (virtual machine) with a real POD HD500; Windows 11 not tested.

Installation

1. Download the **Setup** (`HD500-Editor-Setup-<version>.exe`) or the **portable** build.
2. Windows may show "unknown publisher" (SmartScreen) because the installer is not signed yet: **More info ▸ Run anyway**.
3. At the end the installer offers **Zadig** (bundled). In Zadig: **Options ▸ List All Devices**, pick **POD HD500** (or "Interface 1" if listed), driver **WinUSB**, **Replace Driver**. Windows asks for administrator permission.

4. Open HD500 Editor. If something is still missing, the connection assistant shows the step and has an **Open Zadig** button.

You can also do the Zadig step later from the app's assistant.

How to use it

Connect
Switch the pedal on, plug in the USB cable and open the program. It connects by itself; if something is missing, the connection assistant shows the step and a button to fix it.

Pick and edit
Choose a preset in the sidebar (**B** opens the library, **L** searches all presets). Click a block in the chain to edit its parameters; drag blocks before/after the amp and between paths A and B (**Alt + arrows** moves by keyboard).

Live editing
With **Live editing** on, every change is heard on the pedal at once. Nothing is written to the pedal's memory until you press **Save to pedal**.

Compare and undo
Compare switches between the saved version and your edits. Undo and redo are in the top bar.

Tempo
The **Tap** button (or the **T** key) sets the preset tempo; changing the tempo on the pedal updates the editor.

Library
In the sidebar's **…** menu: rename sets, copy, swap, clear, drag between slots, export and import the whole library and official **.h5e** presets.

Backups
Before every write the slot's previous content is stored. File ▸ Backups restores it.

AI (optional)
Pedal settings has a switch for the AI assistant (MCP). Leave it off if you do not use it.

Your presets are safe

- Edits only touch the edit buffer; the pedal's memory changes only when you save.
- Switching presets with unsaved edits asks first.
- Every write backs up what was in the slot.

Common problems

"POD HD500 not found"	USB cable, pedal switched on, another program using the pedal (close Line 6's official editor).
"No permission" (Linux)	Install the udev rule (assistant button, or see Installation) and re-plug the cable.

“WinUSB driver” (Windows)	Run Zadig as described under Installation. If Line 6’s audio driver is installed it owns the pedal and the editor cannot connect.
The app says connected but nothing answers	Unplug and re-plug the cable; the app recovers the connection by itself.

Independent program, not affiliated with Line 6 or Yamaha Guitar Group. Brand names belong to their owners.